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General Comment

Aymara is a company that develops AI alignment tools and works with enterprises. We believe strongly that advancing the "Right to Align" unlocks AI innovation, strengthening American economic competitiveness, and ensuring national security.

The "Right to Align" is the idea that users—organizations and individual consumers—should have the ability to shape and customize the AI they rely on. This principle is directly inspired by the "Right to Repair" movement, which has allowed consumers to fix and modify their devices rather than being locked into restrictive manufacturer controls. Just as the Right to Repair has driven competition, lowered costs, and given users more control over their technology, the Right to Align can bring similar benefits to the AI ecosystem.

AI alignment capabilities ensure AI is reliable, effective, and aligned with user needs. Customizable AI not only improves outcomes for users but also expands AI's potential in critical sectors such as healthcare, defense, and cybersecurity. As geopolitical competition over AI technology intensifies, ensuring that American-developed AI is flexible and adaptable will maintain national security and economic leadership.

To advance this goal, the United States should promote industry-driven standards that encourage user-configurable AI. Public-private partnerships and targeted incentives can accelerate the development of alignment tools while ensuring customization practices align with industry best practices. By fostering collaboration between AI providers, enterprises, and policymakers, the United States can create a robust framework for responsible, effective AI customization that supports innovation and security.

Promoting the Right to Align can strike a thoughtful balance between AI customization and intellectual property protection. The Right to Repair movement has shown that controlled access to repair tools and software can balance innovation with proprietary interests. Similarly, industry-wide standards for AI alignment ensure that customization empowers users without undermining incentives for AI development. By leading the effort to define best practices that balance flexibility with safeguarding AI investments, the United States promotes innovation while protecting AI advancements.

AI alignment tools should be designed with accessibility, usability, and flexibility in mind. Making these tools available to a broad range of stakeholders—including smaller organizations and independent developers—democratizes AI and enables innovation to thrive at all levels. When more people can shape AI, we create a more open and resilient AI landscape.

We urge the Administration to make the Right to Align a central pillar of its AI Action Plan. Policies that promote alignment transparency, user adaptability, and customization will ensure that AI serves the interests of its users while advancing American leadership in AI innovation and security. By taking this approach, the United States establishes itself as a global leader in adaptable AI while fostering a more open and empowered AI ecosystem.